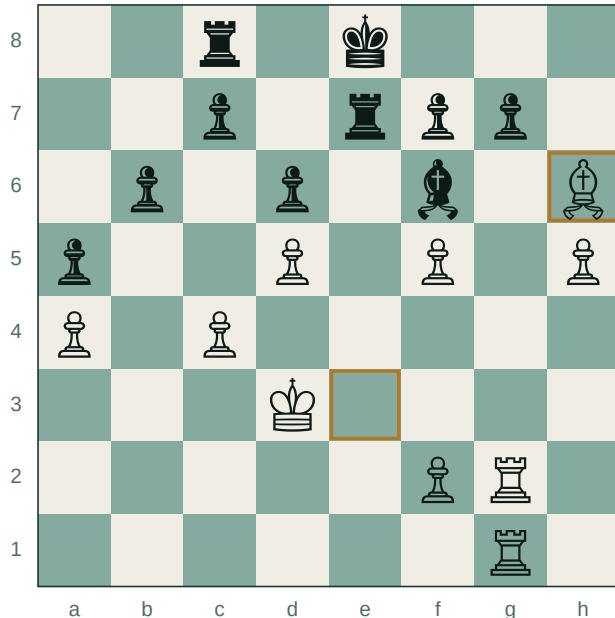


Loose-piece tactics: Black, move 30

Loose-piece tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 30.Bxh6. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

30...gxh6 31. Rg8+ Kd7 32. Rxc8 Kxc8

30...gxh6 The pawn captures the bishop on h6. Recorded reply: **31.Rg8+**.

31...Kd7 The king moves from e8 to d7. The changed line means the rook on c8 attacks the rook on g8. Recorded reply: **32.Rxc8**.

32...Kxc8 The king captures the rook on c8.

At the end, nominal material is White 11 / Black 14 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +3: the balance goes from +0 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A piece may appear hanging because its defender is indirect: taking it might allow mate, a fork, or a stronger capture.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

An undefended or tactically undefendable piece can turn an ordinary position into a combination. The first task is to distinguish a truly free capture from a poisoned one.

HOW TO LOOK

List the loose enemy pieces and check whether a forcing move can expose or attack more than one of them.

The defending king is on d3. Geometrically undefended: bishop on h6. Check for tactical protection.